



The gentle giant

Although all sharks eat meat, not all of them eat big prey. This basking shark is an underwater giant but eats only the tiniest creatures. It gulps huge amounts of water and filters tiny animal plankton from it.

Rays' mouths are underneath their bodies. They have very strong teeth to crush shells with.



Rays swim by flapping their side fins just like wings.

Rays

Rays are sharks' cousins, but unlike their relatives, they are flat, and live mostly on the seabed, in shallow, warm water.



Spotted ray

Turn and learn

Large sea animals that feed by filtering tiny animals:
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Spot the eyes

Most rays are coloured to match the seabed, but they also bury into the sand for extra camouflage. Blue spotted stingrays bury themselves with just their eyes showing when they rest.



Some rays, such as stingrays, have spines on their tails that can sting a predator.

Monster of the deep

The manta ray is the monster in the family, sometimes stretching 6 m (20 ft) across – that's almost the length of a bus! Some swim in small shoals, but most live alone.